

“On Leaving | On Staying Behind”

Developed by Jennifer Fletcher

MODULE: TEACHER VERSION

Grade 12, 2 weeks

ERWC with Integrated and Designated ELD

Module Purpose

The focus of this module is on negotiating different perspectives and meanings in a set of paired poems in preparation for writing creatively about immigrant experiences. The poems, “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” (2014) by American Book Award-winner Diana Garcia, relate the experiences of a daughter and her mother as they contemplate the causes and possible effects of the daughter’s decision to leave her village and emigrate to a different country. The dialogic interaction between the poems and shifts in point of view make these literary texts rich candidates for rhetorical analysis, including discussion of ethos and context. The poems’ subject matter—the push factors and risks of emigration—also make them an excellent vehicle for introducing or reinforcing the concept of exigence: a critical need or problem that calls for a response.

Questions at Issue

- How are individuals impacted by the experience of emigration?
- What does it mean to understand a text or perspective on its own terms?
- What immigrant stories or perspectives are especially important to understand at this time?

Module Texts

Fletcher, Jennifer. “Interview with Diana Garcia.” 17 July 2017.

Garcia, Diana. “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” *Prairie Schooner*, vol. 88, no. 4, 2014, pp. 11-13.

Garcia, Diana. Audio Recording of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” 6 June 2018.

Module Learning Goals – ELA with Integrated ELD

At the conclusion of the module, students will be able to

- Describe how a poet’s choices create meaning
- Analyze the effects and functions of a poet’s choices
- Understand and respond to a critical need or issue addressed by a literary text
- Make connections across texts and conversations
- Use literary strategies to produce a creative work

Module Learning Goals: Designated ELD

At the conclusion of the module, students will be able to

- Understand the rhetorical effects of verbs and adjectives
- Make strategic language choices

Rhetorical Concepts

The rhetorical concepts emphasized in this module are perspective, ethos, context, and exigence.

English Language Arts Standards

Emphasized in this module are the following English language arts (ELA) standards for grades 11-12: Reading Literature 1-2, 5; Writing 3-4.

English Language Development Standards

Emphasized in this module are the following English language development (ELD) standards for grades 11-12: Part I. B. Interpretive, 6, Bridging; Part II, A. Structuring Cohesive Texts, 1, Bridging.

Defining Features of the Module

The module offers students an extended opportunity to read and respond to literary texts rhetorically. Special attention is given to text-to-text connections (e.g., poem-to-poem and poems-to-interview) and to the purposes, exigencies, and contexts of literary texts. The module also affords students the opportunity to develop their skill in close reading.

In addition to the poems, the module includes an interview with Garcia regarding the context and purpose of the poems, including Garcia's source of inspiration. Instructional activities in the module help students connect Garcia's purpose and craft choices to the sense of exigence she describes in the interview. Students demonstrate their understanding of what Garcia says (i.e., themes or messages) and how she says this (i.e., language choices, structure, characterization, point of view, imagery, etc.) through a brief literary analysis. They then will have the opportunity to respond to a critical need, problem, or issue raised by or related to the poems through creative writing.

The Introducing Exigence mini-module can be paired with this module.

Culminating Task

This module includes two major writing tasks: a brief, one-page literary analysis and a creative response to the issues and contexts Garcia addresses in her poems. The literary analysis will engage students in a close reading of the choices Garcia has made as a poet and the meanings she creates through those choices (i.e., themes). The brief analysis will be completed as part of the reading rhetorically activities.

For the culminating writing task, students will choose one of three creative forms: a set of paired poems, a profile feature article, or a work of creative nonfiction (e.g., memoir or a reflective essay). The task thus

afford students an opportunity to apply their understanding of literary craft, narrative strategies, and descriptive language to an original composition.

NOTE: ERWC Modules with Integrated and Designated ELD: Modules with integrated ELD instruction support the acquisition of academic English for all students including English learners (ELs). The designated ELD curriculum additionally provides a full college-preparatory course for English learners at the Expanding and Bridging levels. In order to make collaboration between the teachers of the ERWC and companion ELD classes as seamless as possible, the Module Plan lays out two parallel curriculums following a day-by-day sequence. Intended for 50 minute periods, it shows the activities designed for both settings and the accompanying ELA and ELD standards. The Module Plan can serve as the basis for adapting the module for the variety of settings in which instruction is delivered.

Each module is organized by days. In the Teacher Version, each day begins with the activities intended for the ERWC class and specifies the activity name, following the ERWC template, the purpose and suggested time for each activity along with a suggested procedure for teachers to consult as they plan how to implement the activity. Shaded boxes indicate student activities (possible handouts) with sample student responses in *italics*. In most cases, the italicized responses are not meant to be definitive correct answers; rather they are an example of an acceptable level of understanding. In addition, many activities exist only in the Teacher Version since no separate handout is required. The corresponding day for the designated class follows immediately and is set apart in a box with double borders. It follows the same pattern of activity name, suggested time, purpose, and procedure with a shaded box for student activities. In the event the module is being used where ELs do not have access to a designated class, the ELA teacher is encouraged to pull in activities from the designated portion of the module to support the academic language development of English learners and other students in the ERWC class.

Reading Rhetorically

Text 1 – Garcia, “On Leaving | On Staying Behind”

Preparing to Read

Day 1

Activity 1: Getting Ready to Read – Quickwrite

Purpose: To prepare students to understand Garcia's characters and purpose

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

As your students begin to work with the ERWC “Arc” in these opening activities, keep in mind that the ERWC Assignment Template represents the literate behaviors students internalize through extended practice reading and writing rhetorically.

Reading rhetorically, the literacy practice emphasized in the first half of the Arc, involves an awareness of how readers’ perspectives and identities contribute to the process of meaning-making. In the following quickwrite, students reflect on the personal strengths and assets that help them deal with challenges.

Instruct students to respond to the prompt in Activity 1 in a four-minute quickwrite. Encourage students to write for the full time. You may want to use a timer for this activity. Invite students to share their responses after they finish writing.

Activity 1: Getting Ready to Read – Quickwrite

Prompt: Describe your best qualities or assets.

- What personal strengths and resources do you rely on to help you deal with difficult situations?
- How do you prepare to face challenges?
- What strategies do you use to promote your success?

Activity 2: Exploring Key Concepts – Exigence Concept Map

Purpose: To build students’ conceptual understanding of exigence—a rhetorical term meaning a “defect” or “obstacle” that can be changed by rhetorical action (Bitzer 221)

Understanding this concept can help students read and write more effectively.

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 2: Exploring Key Concepts – Exigence Concept Map

This activity, adapted from *Words, Words, Words* (1999) by Janet Allen, will help you explore the rhetorical concept of **exigence**, or a need or problem that can be addressed through rhetoric. The word **exigence** also has meaning outside of rhetoric studies. First, read the definitions of **exigence** from the Oxford English Dictionary (OED). Then use the model that follows to deepen your understanding of the way an exigence can motivate people to write, speak, or act in various situations.

For the section on your definition, you may synthesize and paraphrase the OED definitions of **exigence** in a way that make sense to you.

For the section on your personal examples, list problems or needs that motivate you to take rhetorical action. For your non-examples, list things that you do not consider to be urgent and important.

Definitions of **Exigence** from the OED (accessed February 24, 2018):

1. What is needed or required; a thing wanted or demanded; a requirement, a necessity.
2. A state of urgent need; a situation of trouble or difficulty; an extremity; (in pl.) straits.
3. Urgent need or demand; necessity; emergency; great trouble or difficulty.

Concept Map	
Concept:	My Definition:
Synonyms:	My Sentence:
My Personal Examples:	My Non-Examples

As you read “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” think about the exigencies motivating the poet to write and her characters to act.

Activity 3: Surveying the Text

Purpose: To give students a framework for understanding by asking them to consider the title and form of the text

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

“On Leaving | On Staying Behind” by Diana Garcia are narrative poems describing emigrant experiences from the perspectives of a mother and daughter. The daughter’s point of view is shared first. Encourage students to notice the unusual double title of the paired poems. For additional information about Garcia, see The Poetry Foundation, Diana Garcia www.poetryfoundation.org/poets/diana-garcia.

Note: Because the reading selections in this module are so short, the Assignment Template section on “Making Predictions and Asking Questions” has been omitted. If you believe your students would benefit from additional preparation for reading, you may invite students to make predictions and ask questions about the texts. See the ERWC Activity Template for sample activities.

Activity 3: Surveying the Text

What are your thoughts when you read the titles? In what kinds of situations might some people leave while others stay behind? What do you notice about the form of Garcia’s writing? How is the experience of reading a poem different from reading a short story or novel?

The title tells you right away that there will be two different viewpoints, so you’ll be able to see both emotions.

The word “on” makes you think someone is going to be talking on a subject. The title also gives a clear purpose.

Activity 4: Understanding Key Vocabulary

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Purpose: To introduce key English and Spanish words in the poems that may be unfamiliar to students. You may decide to have students complete Activities 4 and 5 for homework.

Activity 4: Understanding Key Vocabulary

The following list of words and phrases from the poems have been defined for you. It will be helpful to know these definitions as you read the poems. Use an online dictionary if you would like to hear how these words are pronounced.

1. Coyotes: Smugglers
2. Mis primas: My cousins (female)
3. La migra: Border patrol
4. Una profe de los etados unidos: A professor from the United States
5. Serape: Cloak or wrap; bedding
6. Endurance: Stamina or forbearance
7. Persists: Continues or lasts
8. Fleet: Fast or speedy

Activity 5: Creating Personal Learning Goals

Purpose: To create personal learning goals that will help students identify and leverage their personal assets to support their continued academic growth

Activity 5: Creating Personal Learning Goals

Diana Garcia explains in an interview that one of her reasons for writing “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” was to “imagine survival strategies for young women who travel alone in search of a better life” (July 17, 2017). The ability to imagine and bring about our own success is key not only to surviving but also to thriving.

This activity asks you to imagine—and then pursue—learning goals that will help you grow as a thinker and communicator. As you set your goals, you might want to consider the two assignments you will be completing for this module: a short literary analysis and a creative response of your choice. Both assignments require you to read critically and communicate effectively. Consider the following questions:

- What strengths do I have as a reader and writer that I can build on?
- What do I want to learn how to do or do better?
- What do I need to keep me moving forward in my intellectual growth?

Choose two or three goals that are important to you and record these in your notes. Focus on imagining and creating your success as you engage the learning experiences in this module.

Activity 1D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Maps for Emigration and Immigration

Purpose: To continue exploring key concepts by completing concept maps for **emigration** and **immigration** (the first term is especially important for understanding the daughter’s experience as an emigrant)

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Activity 1D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Maps for Emigration and Immigration

Complete the following two concept maps for the terms **emigration** and **immigration**. The poem “On Leaving” addresses the experience of emigration. The poems do not present the perspective of someone who has already immigrated (i.e., entered a new country after leaving their home country). As you read the poems, consider how a person’s perspective as an emigrant might be different from their perspective as an immigrant.

Concept Map – Emigration	
Concept:	Definition:
Key Characteristics:	Sentence:
Things that are related to this concept:	Picture or diagram:

Concept Map – Immigration	
Concept:	Definition:
Key Characteristics:	Sentence:
Things that are related to this concept:	Picture or diagram:

Activity 2D: Exploring Key Concepts – Venn Diagram for Emigration and Immigration

Purpose: The Venn Diagram affords students an additional opportunity to deepen their understanding of the similarities and differences between these two key concepts.

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 2D: Exploring Key Concepts – Venn Diagram for Emigration and Immigration

Now compare these two concepts through a Venn Diagram.

- How are they similar?
- How are they different?

Reading Purposefully

Activity 3D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Signal Word Sort

Purpose: To develop an awareness of the rhetorical functions of signal words or transitions commonly used in compare and contrast writing

Suggested Time: 5 minutes

Activity 3D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Signal Word Sort

Which of the following words can be used to describe similarities between things? Which can be used to describe differences? Sort these signal words into two different categories:

in the same way	similarly	in contrast
like	unlike	both
conversely	whereas	on the other hand
likewise	despite	although

Activity 4D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Compare and Contrast Paragraph Scramble

Purpose: To extend and apply their understanding of text structure and signal words through a Paragraph Scramble

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 4D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Compare and Contrast Paragraph Scramble

This activity has been adapted from the California Reading and Literature Project. The sentences that follow are from a paragraph comparing and contrasting emigration and immigration. The order of these sentences has been scrambled. Working with a partner or small group, arrange these sentences in an order that makes sense as a complete paragraph. Use your knowledge of signal words to unscramble the paragraph.

1. Thus, we can say a person emigrates from a place and immigrates into a place.
2. Many people confuse the terms emigration and immigration.
3. This word starts with the prefix e-, which means “out” or “away from.”
4. Both the term emigration and the term immigration describe aspects of transnational migration or movement from one country to another.
5. Emigration describes the act of leaving one’s homeland.
6. Ultimately, the important idea to remember is that both emigration and immigration are acts of migration but they differ in their direction and point of view.

7. This word starts with the prefix im-, which means “into,” “in,” or “towards.”
8. While these terms are related and share important similarities, there are also important differences between these terms.
9. The word immigration, on the other hand, describes the act of entering a new country.

Many people confuse the terms emigration and immigration. While these terms are related and share important similarities, there are also important differences between these terms. Both the term emigration and the term immigration describe aspects of transnational migration or movement from one country to another. Emigration describes the act of leaving one’s homeland. This word starts with the prefix e-, which means “out” or “away from.” The word immigration, on the other hand, describes the act of entering a new country. This word starts with the prefix im-, which means “into,” “in,” or “towards.” Thus, we can say a person emigrates from a place and immigrates into a place. Ultimately, the important idea to remember is that both emigration and immigration are acts of migration but they differ in their direction and point of view.

Activity 5D: Understanding Key Vocabulary – Word Families

Purpose: Exploring word families (words that are formed from the same base word but have different grammatical forms) can help students develop morphological awareness (i.e., awareness of roots, prefixes, and suffixes) and perform word transformations (i.e., changing a noun to a verb). Students can complete Activity 4D in their notes for homework.

Activity 5D: Understanding Key Vocabulary – Word Families

For each word in the groups that follow, identify the part of speech (noun or verb) and write a brief definition in your notes. Then draw a picture or diagram showing your understanding of this word.

1. migrate, migrant, migration
2. immigrate, immigrant, immigration
3. emigrate, emigrant, emigration

Reading Purposefully

Reading for Understanding

Day 2

Activity 6: Reading for Understanding – Pairs Conversation

Purpose: To orient students to the poems’ subject

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Ask students to read the two poems silently. Let students know that you will be reading these poems several times in different ways. Now play the audio recording of Diana Garcia reading “On Leaving |

On Staying Behind” (you can find the audio file of Garcia reading her poems in the ERWC Online Community). After listening to the recorded reading, ask students to discuss their initial understanding of the poems with a partner. Share the questions in Activity 6 as prompts.

Activity 6: Reading for Understanding – Pairs Conversation

After reading and listening to the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” discuss the questions that follow with a partner.

- What are these poems about? What’s the time, place, and occasion?
- What’s the daughter’s situation? What’s the mother’s situation?
- What ideas or images stand out to you?

Activity 7: Reading for Understanding – Interrupted Reading

Purpose: To engage students in a “slow” reading of the text that allows them to notice and analyze Garcia’s language choices

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

For the third reading, students engage in a close study of the first poem, “On Leaving,” through an interrupted reading. The class reads only a few lines at a time, stopping and analyzing the poet’s language and stylistic choices after each set of lines.

Prepare for this activity by creating a slide presentation in which only two lines from “On Leaving” are displayed on each slide (see the example that follows). As you show each slide to the class, ask one student to read the two lines aloud. Using equitable discussion strategies, choose a different student to read each slide. After the student has read the two lines, stop and have a whole-class discussion about what they notice. Invite students to share their observations about the poet’s choices and the significance and effects of those choices. Be sure to allow “wait time” for students to respond.

You may want to remind students that there are multiple ways of reading and purposes for reading. The second and third readings of the poems are intended to move students from a surface response to a deeper understanding.

Sample Transcript of an Interrupted Reading of “On Leaving”:

I can run five times around the village, my dog beside me. I have tested myself against her speed, my younger cousins’ endurance. I win.

Teacher: What do you notice? What words are important here?

Student A: When she says “I win” in the end, it shows how much determination she has.

Student B: You can immediately see how much confidence she has.

Teacher: Why is it important that the dog is in there? What does this show about her character?

Student C: She’s loyal. Relationships are important to her.

Student D: She’s fast.

Student E: It also shows she has to leave the dog behind.

**My cousins go with me this morning, their dark hair glossy, so young
their shoulders. Their mothers tell me to watch over them.**

Teacher: Now what stands out?

Student C: She's trustworthy.

Student D: She's old enough to look over her younger cousins.

Student E: I want to add on to that. She's basically the oldest of the group, but they're all so young.

Teacher: What else?

Student A: What do we learn about the cousins?

Student F: She's kind of committing them to memory because she has to leave them.

Teacher: OK, so that's a good question to hang onto and see if the poem answers later. There are two sets of cousins in the poem—the younger male cousins and the older female cousins. Which cousins are these? We might have to read more to find out.

**I have said goodbye to all who remain, grayed village elders,
wooden statues of saints in our small church, my mother.**

Teacher: What do you notice here?

Student F: She knows she might not see the people she loves again. She's said her goodbyes which I imagine was pretty hard.

Teacher: What else do you notice?

Student G: It sounds like everyone else is gone. The only people who are left are the elderly.

Teacher: What else?

Student D: Also the mother is her hardest goodbye because she saves that for the end and ends it with a period. It ends the thought process.

Student B: It's really hard for her to put her feelings into words. That's why the sentence is so short.

**I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest
of the girl cousins, no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here.**

Teacher: What do you notice about this? What do you see?

Student H: There's nothing holding her back. There's nothing there for her.

Teacher: What do you notice about the way she expresses that idea?

Student B: We hear "no" twice. She repeats "no."

Student G: She says she's the youngest, so she's not married.

Student I: It hurts me to see her down on herself because we as readers see how strong she is.

Teacher: OK, this is a great place to ask a question. Does the idea of wealth show up anywhere else in the poems? Who recognizes her wealth?

Several students: Her mother.

Teacher: Do you think material beauty and wealth are things that the daughter values? That might be a question to ask and then go back and see if the poems have an answer.

**I wear only what I have. I carry a blouse one aunt gave me,
a friend's old sandals for days when heat persists into the night.**

Teacher: What do you notice?

Student H: That she literally has nothing to take with her. She doesn't have anything of her own. What she has is given to her by her aunt and a friend.

Student B: It makes you think why she's leaving in the first place. Is she going to find a better life?

Teacher: How about that word "persists"? What does that suggest to you?

Student J: Her cousins' advice about traveling in the night because of the heat.

Student K: It suggests the difficult conditions.

**My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early
in the morning and at night. When you reach the trains, gain a space**

Teacher: What do you see here?

Student H: I'm not sure. I'm trying to put it into words.

Teacher: OK, what do you see that's visually different about these lines?

Student H: There's no period at the end.

Teacher: Good. What else?

Student C: A colon.

Teacher: Excellent. What does a colon do rhetorically?

Student L: It introduces an important idea.

Student B: And it makes it sound like someone else is talking. It's her cousin's advice.

Teacher: Right—it shifts the voice. The colon almost functions as quotation marks.

Student L: It shows what's in her memory.

**in the middle; don't move. Don't let anyone steal your space. When we
reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing yellow bandanas,**

Teacher: What do you notice?

Student A: She has to be careful, like attentive.

Student B: That she comes from a country in Central America.

Teacher: How do you know that?

Student B: Because she's trying to reach Mexico.

Student M: It makes me wonder about the significance of yellow bandanas and if she's talking about actual coyotes.

Teacher: So these are questions we ask as we're working to understand the poem. When you have questions like that, you can try to find the answers in the text itself, you can read scholarship on

the text, or you can ask other people in your discussion group. So let's start by asking this class: Does anyone know what the daughter means by "coyotes"?

Student L: Coyotes? Smugglers. They're the ones who smuggle people across the border.

Teacher: And what's the significance of the yellow bandanas?

Student L: It's like identification for people who speak their language.

Teacher: OK, what we're doing is constructing meaning from all the available evidence. What else do these lines tell you about her preparation? What else is she prepared to do besides run?

Student B: I'd say fight because she's prepared to defend her space.

**not red or green. Those wearing yellow come from our region,
they speak our language, they are known to our village.**

Teacher: What stands out to you about these lines?

Student N: The fact that the coyotes wearing the yellow bandanas come from their village, so they're more trustworthy.

Student P: The "not red or green" lets the reader know there are more people trying to get away.

Student T: And it shows she has to be careful not to end up lost or with the wrong group.

**If no one waits at the border wearing yellow, we wait or take
our chances. I have waited two years for this chance. No more.**

Teacher: What's important here?

Student C: She's determined to leave. She's waited two years.

Student L: Makes me wonder what she means by taking her chances. What would that action be?

Teacher: How is "taking our chances" different from waiting "two years for this chance"?

Student B: What do you mean?

Teacher: OK, what would be another way of saying "waited for this chance"?

Student R: Opportunity.

Teacher: What are the connotations of opportunity? What are the feelings we associate with that word?

Student B: Like it's now or never.

Student K: It's rare, special.

Student L: Like relief if it happens.

Teacher: What does it mean to take your chances?

Student M: Risk.

Teacher: Right—the line pivots from the risks to the potential rewards.

**If the coyotes separate me from my two cousins, mis primas
instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life.**

Teacher: What's important here?

Student I: It's OK for them to get separated?

Teacher: “Mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life.” What can they take?

Student S: Her money?

Teacher: Does she have money?

Student R: Take her life?

Student B: The cousins said don’t let them take her life.

Teacher: What else could they take? Let’s read more and see if the poem answers that question.

**They think I don’t know what they mean. I know what a man
can take from a woman. I know my younger cousins’ pride.**

Student F: They could take her virginity or something like that.

Student R: It’s about rape.

Teacher: Why does she say “I know my younger cousins’ pride”?

Student T: She knows about their pride in protecting her, and she’s worried about them getting hurt.

Teacher: What’s her concern?

Student N: That her cousins might fight back. That if she’s sexually assaulted, her cousins could get killed.

Student M: This also shows that she’s mature and aware because her older cousins don’t think she understands about the threat of rape, but she does.

**I will protect them from their pride, our family honor. I will scream
or fight if I can. I will run if I can. I know now how fast I can run.**

Teacher: These are the last lines of the poem. As rhetorical readers, we pay special attention to how writers conclude their texts. What’s important about these final lines?

Student D: The first two lines start with how she knows she can run, and the last two end with she knows how fast she can run.

Teacher: So that’s a good observation about the structure. We have a frame structure. It comes full circle.

Student G: We have an idea now why she was preparing so hard.

Student K: At the beginning, it was in the past tense, and now it’s in the future tense.

Teacher: What does she mean “I will protect them from their pride”?

Student D: She’ll prevent them from fighting and getting killed.

Teacher: And is she planning on following her older cousins’ advice to “let them take what they want” but not her life?

Student P: No, she’s planning to do things her own way.

Student F: She’s been given this advice, but she’s making up her own plan and rules.

Student J: She’s very headstrong. She’s very intelligent. She’s not going to get raped or let anyone get killed.

Activity 7: Reading for Understanding – Interrupted Reading

For this activity, you will be participating in an interrupted reading of the poem “On Leaving.” This kind of slow reading helps you gain a deeper understanding of a text. Your teacher will show you only two lines from the poem at a time. After reading the lines, discuss what you notice as a class. Consider Garcia’s word choice (including word connotations), sentence structure, imagery, and anything else that seems important. Annotate your copy of the poem as you discuss the lines.

Activity 8: Annotating and Questioning the Text

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Purpose: To give students an opportunity to further respond independently to the poem

Students will continue annotating the poems by making additional marginal notations (e.g., asking questions, expressing surprise, disagreeing, elaborating, and noting any instances of confusion). These activities can be completed outside of class or independently as part of a gradual release of responsibility. The goal of the multiple readings is to help students think critically about the intent and impact of the writer’s choices.

Activity 8: Annotating and Questioning the Text

Now continue annotating and questioning both poems on your own. Write your annotations on your copies of the poems before responding to the questions below.

1. What does the daughter mean when she says, “I have tested myself against her speed, my younger cousins’ endurance”? What does this show about her character?

The daughter means that she has prepared herself for this moment. This shows that she is a very confident, strong, and mature person. She’s realistic about the dangers she’s facing.

2. Who are the other characters in these poems? What do they help us understand about the situations the mother and daughter are facing?

The other characters in the poems are the older female cousins, the younger male cousins, her mother, the professor, and the grayed village elders. These people help us understand the connections and values the mother and daughter have and also how other people see them. When the daughter is saying goodbye, we see she has a sincere connection to her small village and although she’s sad to leave, it’s for the greater good. Furthermore, the older cousins help us understand the situation the daughter’s facing because they’ve already experienced it.

3. What is the significance of the different colored bandanas? What does this detail help us understand about the daughter’s situation? About the larger context for the poems?

The different colors expand the scope of the experience; this isn’t just happening to the daughter’s village. There are people from other places who speak other languages who are also leaving their homelands. The daughter’s experience is part of a bigger story of transnational migrations.

Activity 6D: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Paragraph Reconstruction

Purpose: To practice close listening as students reconstruct a paragraph which then becomes a mentor text for literary interpretation

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

This day's lesson begins with a paragraph reconstruction that serves as a model of literary interpretation. When students have finished their reconstructions, invite them to share the reconstructions with the class. Students then practice close reading in collaborative groups by creating T-chart posters. Each group will work together using a T-chart (or double-entry journal) to analyze quotations from the poems. Students will record the quotations in the left column of the T-chart and will write their interpretations of the quotations in the right column. The lesson concludes with a quickwrite on Garcia's theme(s).

The purpose of Activity 6D is to elicit a paragraph of student writing on the meaning of the poems. Using these paragraphs, you can informally diagnose students' strengths and weaknesses in the area of sentence construction. At the end of the activity, students edit their paragraphs, applying what they have learned about grammar, usage, and mechanics. They then compare their paragraphs with the original, paying particular attention to the moves writers make when interpreting literary texts.

Selected Paragraph (read aloud to students)

In "On Leaving | On Staying Behind," Garcia uses the daughter as an example of the determination of immigrants. Garcia thus conveys to the reader the qualities that many immigrants bring to the United States. The mother also comments on the strength and resilience of her daughter by stating that she can "see the strength in [her] arms and shoulders, blood that pumps through heart and lungs" (9-10). This section is significant because Garcia deliberately portrays the strength of youth through the daughter. Through this portrayal, the poet suggests the promising future that awaits many young migrants traveling to the United States in pursuit of a better life.

Activity 6D: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Paragraph Reconstruction

In this activity, you will be reconstructing a paragraph that your teacher reads aloud to you. As you listen to your teacher, pay attention to the way the writer interprets Garcia's poems.

Step One: Take out a blank sheet of paper.

Step Two: Listen as your instructor reads the selected paragraph at a normal rate of speed.

Step Three: Then take notes while your instructor reads the paragraph again; the notes will be essential when composing your paragraph.

Step Four: Reconstruct what you heard using your notes or the keywords. Compare what you have written with other students and make changes as necessary.

Step Five: Finally, compare your reconstruction to the original paragraph. Edit your paragraph as needed.

Questioning the Text

Activity 7D: Thinking Critically – T-Chart Posters

Purpose: To select and evaluate the meaning of key quotations in the poems

Suggest Time: 20 minutes

Activity 7D: Thinking Critically – T-Chart Posters

Work together in groups to examine quotations from the poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” You will need a large piece of chart paper and markers for this activity. After each person writes something with a marker (either a quotation or an interpretation of a quotation), he or she will pass the marker to a new person.

Step One: Create a T-chart on your poster. Label the left side “Quotations” and the right side “Interpretations.”

Step Two: Choose four quotations from the poems that you think are especially important. Write these quotations in the left column of your poster.

Step Three: Discuss what each quotation means and why it matters as a group. Then write an interpretation of each quotation in the right column of your poster, using the following sentence starters as needed:

This quotation shows...

This quotation suggests...

This example is important because...

These words reveal...

This raises the question...

This represents...

Garcia’s words portray...

Activity 8D: Thinking Critically – Quickwrite

Purpose: To articulate the messages that Garcia conveys and the ways in which she communicates the messages in the poems

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 8D: Thinking Critically – Quickwrite

Respond to the following questions in a five-minute quickwrite:

- What does Garcia seem to be saying through her poems?
- How does she present this message or messages?

Share your quickwrite with a partner.

Questioning the Text

Day 3

Activity 9: Thinking Critically – Dialogic 3-Chart

Purpose: To deepen students’ understanding of the two poems through a comparison of the speakers’ perspectives

Suggest Time: 20 minutes

In this activity, students compare the perspectives of the speakers in the two poems and also practice collecting textual evidence (in this case, direct quotations) that they can later use in their literary analysis.

Ask students to fill out the chart below. To help students find matching sets of lines—that is, lines from “On Leaving” and “On Staying Behind” that seem to speak to each other in some way—you can cut the poems into individual sentence strips. Place all the sentence strips for “On Leaving” in one envelope and all the sentence strips for “On Staying Behind” in another envelope. Then give the envelopes to groups of students and ask students to sort the strips into pairs on a table or desk. After students find their “matches,” you can have pairs of students read aloud the statements from the daughter’s and the mother’s point of view as a kind of call and response. Hearing the way the mother’s story speaks back to the daughter’s helps students understand the dialogic connection between the poems.

Activity 9: Thinking Critically – Dialogic 3-Chart

The paired poems speak to each other in important ways. Sometimes the connection is direct, as when both the daughter and the mother speaks about the daughter’s ability to run fast. At other times the connection is indirect, as when the mother and daughter describe the different challenges they face.

For this activity, you will be matching lines from the two poems that seem to relate to each other in important ways and then synthesizing these lines to make an interpretive claim about the meaning of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” Think about how the two poems—and the two perspectives—work together to create a cohesive whole. What do both voices contribute to our understanding of the experience of emigration?

Write your matching quotations from the poems in the first two columns of the 3-Chart. In the third column, “Combined Significance,” write your interpretative claims about how the two quotations from the individual poems contribute to the meaning of the work as a whole.

An example has been done for you.

	Lines from “On Leaving”	Lines from “On Staying Behind”	Combined Significance
1	“I know now how fast I can run.”	“She thinks I don’t know why she runs.”	Both the daughter and mother understand the dangers of the journey, as well as the daughter’s ability to deal with those dangers. These lines also show the women’s reluctance to talk openly about their worst fears. The journey and the separation must be handled with courage and self-discipline.

2			
3			
4			
5			

Reading Purposefully

Activity 10: Negotiating Meaning – Structured Discussion

Purpose: To help students engage alternative perspectives and readings as a strategy for deeper reading

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Students practice negotiating meaning by testing their interpretations of a text against those of other readers, as well as by working to make sense of any difficulties or inconsistencies in a text. The purpose of this activity is to help students engage alternative perspectives and readings as a strategy for deeper reading.

Begin by establishing norms for productive discussion, including listening with the purpose of understanding and allowing others to finish speaking before the next person responds. Then model the structured discussion with a single demonstration group before organizing the whole class into groups of four.

The topic of the discussion will be about the role of self-efficacy in promoting success. As students talk, take notes about how students conduct their discussion. Review and adjust learning community norms as needed. Invite Student 4 in each group to share their take-away understandings with the whole class.

Activity 10: Negotiating Meaning – Structured Discussion

In your group, number yourselves 1-4. Each person will have a specific role during the discussion (see the discussion questions that follow).

Step One: Students 1 and 2 will begin the discussion while students 3 and 4 take notes in a T-chart. The T-chart will be a record of the main points and examples discussed by Students 1 and 2. Students 1 and 2 will have five minutes for their dialogue.

Student 1	Student 2

Step Two: Student 3 now summarizes the discussion and then asks for elaboration or clarification on one underdeveloped but important point AND joins the conversation while 4 continues to take notes in a 3-chart (see the example below). Students 1, 2, and 3 will have seven more minutes to continue the discussion. Try using the sentence starters that follow to help each other elaborate upon and clarify your ideas:

- Can you elaborate on this...?
- What do you mean by...?

- Can you tell me more about...?
- What makes you think that?
- Can you clarify the part about...?
- Can you be more specific?
- How so?
- How/why is that important? (Zwiers and Crawford 32).

Student 4 records key points and examples in the 3-chart.

Student 1	Student 2	Student 3

Step Three: Student 4 now gives credit to individuals for significant ideas and synthesizes work of the group into a short statement. Groups may have five minutes for this final step.

Discussion Questions:

Self-efficacy is a concept in education that means “faith in your own effort and effectiveness.” A person with a strong sense of self-efficacy trusts that he or she will be able to figure out how to be successful under a variety of difficult circumstances.

- How much faith do you think the daughter has in her own strength? To what extent do you think she trusts her own ability to find a way to survive? How do you know? What do other characters say? Is there any textual evidence that contradicts this view?
- How is self-efficacy different from motivation or determination?
- How important do you think it is for people to have confidence in their own assets and strengths? Who are people you know with a strong sense of self-efficacy? To what extent does this sense of self-efficacy help them succeed?

Activity 11: Examining the Structure of the Text – Descriptive Outline of “On Staying Behind”

Purpose: To help students to analyze the form and functions of the poems’ structure, including how the poet develops and supports her ideas, as well as the rhetorical effects of her choices

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

If your students already have extensive experience with descriptive outlining, they may complete Activity 11 as homework. The purpose of this activity is to deepen students’ understanding of the effects and functions of the poet’s development moves (i.e., the organization of the poems and the progression of ideas). You can offer students an additional challenge by asking them to descriptively outline both poems without showing them a model first.

Activity 11: Examining the Structure of the Text – Descriptive Outline of “On Staying Behind”

Take a few minutes to notice the structure of the two poems. How many lines does each poem have? What is the effect of this? Do the lines rhyme? Are there other similarities between the structure of the paired poems? Discuss your observations with a partner.

As an exercise in understanding the poem’s internal structure, divide “On Staying Behind” (the poem told from the mother’s perspective) into separate stanzas. What do you see as the functional sections of the poem? Where are the shifts? Where do you see the poem change its focus? Draw lines across the page separating the poem into different chunks.

Now use your descriptive outlining skills to note what each section is saying and doing. Write your “says” statements in the right margin of the poem and your “does” statements in the left margin. See the example that follows for “On Leaving.”

“On Leaving”

Does: Shows the daughter has a lot of strength, endurance, and responsibility. She’s willing to persevere.

I can run five times around the village, my dog beside me. I have tested myself against her speed, my younger cousins’ endurance. I win.
My cousins go with me this morning, their dark hair glossy, so young their shoulders. Their mothers tell me to watch over them.

Says: She can run faster than others. Her aunts expect her to take care of her younger cousins.

Does: Shows that she’s doing this for her family; she’s connected to her village; also shows her love for her mother and how the people who stay behind are either old or have money.

I have said goodbye to all who remain, grayed village elders, wooden statues of saints in our small church, my mother.
I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest of the girl cousins, no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here.
I wear only what I have. I carry a blouse one aunt gave me, a friend’s old sandals for days when heat persists into the night.

Says: She has said her goodbyes and is prepared to leave.

Does: Reveals that she’s not the first to go and conveys the mortal dangers of the situation.

My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early in the morning and at night. When you reach the trains, gain a space in the middle; don’t move. Don’t let anyone steal your space. When we reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing yellow bandanas,

Says: Her relatives who have already left have given her advice for the journey. She’s already been waiting two years to leave.

not red or green. Those wearing yellow come from our region,
they speak our language, they are known to our village.
If no one waits at the border wearing yellow, we wait or take
our chances. I have waited two years for this chance. No more.

Does:

Demonstrates her determination, maturity, and confidence. Shows she makes decisions for herself and is more knowledge-able than her older cousins assume. Offers alternatives to rape and murder.

If the coyotes separate me from my two cousins, mis primas
instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life.
They think I don't know what they mean. I know what a man
can take from a woman. I know my younger cousins' pride.
I will protect them from their pride, our family honor. I will scream
or fight if I can. I will run if I can. I know now how fast I can run.

Says: Her cousins who have made the journey have advised her to cooperate with the smugglers. She knows there's a risk of sexual assault. She also knows her younger male cousins would want to protect her and that if they fight the smugglers, they could get killed. She plans to protect herself and her cousins.

Activity 9D: Examining the Structure of the Text

Purpose: To support students in analyzing the significance of the text structure and sentence structure

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

You may want to provide your students with clean copies of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” so that they can annotate the poems from a fresh perspective. You may choose to guide students through these questions as part of a whole-class discussion, modeling your own annotations through a document camera or smart board.

Activity 9D: Examining the Structure of the Text

Answer the questions that follow in your notes.

1. How does each poem start? Why is this important?
2. How does each poem's opening lines orient the reader to the subject?
3. Underline all the lines in the poems that start with pronouns (e.g., I, she, they, my). What do you notice? What are the effects of Garcia's pronouns?
4. Each poem contains a brief narrative or story. The daughter's poem is a hypothetical scenario. The mother's poem is an experience she had that day. Highlight the section of each poem that features a narrative. Circle the transitions Garcia uses to structure these narratives (e.g., when, if, today). What is the significance of these narratives? What do they help us understand?
5. How do the poems' structure and language choices focus the reader's attention?
6. Why do you think the mother's perspective comes after the daughter's perspective?

Questioning the Text

Activity 10D: Thinking Critically – Venn Diagram

Purpose: To compare and contrast the perspectives of the speakers in the two poems

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 10D: Thinking Critically – Venn Diagram

Create a Venn Diagram comparing and contrasting the daughter's and mother's perspectives. This diagram will help you generate ideas for the paragraph you'll be writing next.

Activity 11D: Thinking Critically – Compare and Contrast Paragraph

Purpose: To enable students to summarize their observations about the perspectives in the two poems in a compare and contrast paragraph

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 11D: Thinking Critically – Compare and Contrast Paragraph

Use your knowledge of signal words and text structure to write a paragraph comparing and contrasting the daughter's and mother's perspectives. What do they share in common? How are their situations different? Adapt the sentence starters that follow to fit your own ideas.

- Both the daughter and her mother...
- In the same way, the mother...
- Similarly, the daughter...
- The mother, on the other hand...

- In contrast, the daughter...
- Whereas the mother is...
- Unlike her mother, the daughter...

Day 4

Activity 12: Examining the Structure of the Text – Descriptive Outline of “On Staying Behind” (Review)

Purpose: To give students an opportunity to analyze the structure and rhetorical moves of a second poem

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

If your students completed Activity 11 for homework, begin class by facilitating a whole class discussion of the way students charted the poet’s moves. If students did not complete Activity 11 for homework, they may do so in class now.

Activity 13: Examining the Structure of the Text – Quickwrite or Pairs Conversation

Purpose: To allow students to share their observations about the structure of the poems and Garcia’s rhetorical purpose in structuring the poems as she has

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Formative Assessment: The descriptive outline and quickwrite/pairs conversation are important opportunities to practice assessment of and for learning. What do your students’ responses indicate about the level of support or challenge that will promote their continued growth? Invite your students to participate in the process of formative assessment by reviewing their learning goals and their progress toward these goals as indicated by their performance on this task.

Activity 13: Examining the Structure of the Text – Quickwrite or Pairs Conversation

What do you notice about the structure of the poems? What is Garcia trying to accomplish in each section? Why do you think the poems are not divided into stanzas?

Activity 14: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Kairos Connection

Purpose: To facilitate students’ exploration of the contexts the poems engage

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

You may want to prepare students for this discussion by reviewing the ERWC mini-module, Introducing Kairos, including the article “Choosing the Right Words at the Right Time.”

Activity 14: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Kairos Connection

Kairos is a Greek word meaning “the opportune moment” or “situational time.” We can think of kairos as the immediate social situation in which acts of communication must take place. Exploring the kairos of a rhetorical situation can thus be a way to grapple with an ongoing conversation (one indeed that may have been ongoing for decades or centuries) while also examining how the conversation has changed—and continues to change—in response to recent events.

Questions to guide this thinking could include the following:

- To what extent are these issues relevant today?

The issue of having to leave your family for a better opportunity is always present in the world. I believe that there will never be a time when people stop emigrating from their homeland to another country.

- What opportunities do writers have for addressing these issues today?

The writers are able to share personal experiences if they have any. Also, they are causing awareness by using a social issue as the topic or theme of the text that they are writing.

- To what extent has the conversation on immigration changed since Garcia first published these poems?

I believe this poem came out a couple years ago. The topic of immigration has changed because of a “different perspective” that the President is giving the People. He is making up lies and stereotypes that have his supporters believing that they are true.

- How far back does this issue go? Do you see this text as participating in an ongoing conversation? Why or why not?

This issue basically goes back to the beginning of time. Migration has always been human nature and I believe that this topic will forever be a relevant one since the world is not a good place and it is filled with good people. People from foreign countries cannot control the “good” or “bad” that happens in the countries and that is why migration is a thing.

- What’s changed—culturally, socially, or politically—since the text was first published?

I believe that the only thing that has changed is the political side of this subject because of how the government is perceiving immigrants and the stigma behind immigration as a whole. The U.S voted for a man who hates immigration and wants to build a wall to stop it so that’s what the people of the U.S also want.

- Would older generations have viewed this issue differently from how your generation tends to see it?

No. My lineage comes from immigrants. My parents have migrated from Mexico to the United States and were, fortunately, able to get citizenship and residency so my parents know all about this. They have firsthand experience and memories of stories like this one.

Questioning the Text

Activity 12D: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Interior Monologue

Suggested Time: 40 minutes

Purpose: To afford students practice in exploring different perspectives and in composing a text from a particular point of view, using first-person pronouns

You may find it helpful to review English pronouns with your students before asking them to complete Activity 12D. Then post the chart, so they can see it as they create their interior monologues.

Personal Pronouns						
	Singular			Plural		
First	I	me	my	we	our	us
Second	you	you	your	you	you	you
Third	he	him	his			
	she	her	her			
	it	it	its			

Activity 12D: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Interior Monologue

Perspective taking is an important part of rhetorical thinking. When we analyze rhetorical situations, we consider the different perspectives of those involved.

Step One: Start by circling all the first-person pronouns in the poems (e.g., I, me, my, we, our). Why do you think Garcia chose to use the first-person point of view for her characters? What are the effects of this point of view in the poems? Turn and talk to a partner about these questions.

Step Two: In this next activity, you will practice perspective taking by writing an interior monologue (or inner thoughts) for another character in the poems besides the two main speakers. Choose one of the two perspectives that follow and write a first-person monologue, revealing this character's thoughts during the situation described. Your interior monologue should help your reader see from that character's point of view.

- The perspective of one of the younger cousins as she runs and loses a race against the daughter
- The perspective of una profe de los estados as she spills the mother's pot of beans and watches her pick them up from the dirt

Begin by brainstorming the character's beliefs, values, experiences, and personality traits. Make inferences based on your readings of the poems. Use a cluster or word web to generate ideas for writing. Consider the extent to which this character's perspective differs from the speaker's perspective in the poem (i.e., the daughter or the mother).

Now draft your interior monologue, writing in the voice of the character you selected. What is this character thinking at this particular moment in the poem? Speak the thoughts running through the character's mind (e.g., "This time I know I can win the race! She's not going to beat me today.")

Share your finished interior monologue with a partner.

Reading Purposefully

Activity 13D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Reviewing Adjectives

Purpose: To prepare students for Activity 15: Analyzing the Rhetorical Effects of Adjectives (see Day 5) and also serve as closure for the interior monologue

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Review the definition of an adjective as a class and discuss the example below. You may want to project the pages of the dictionary where "dark" and "glossy" appear to model for students how they can determine if a particular word is an adjective.

Example: their **dark** hair **glossy**

Point out that when you look up "dark" in Longman's the first time the word is listed, it is followed by the abbreviation "adj." that indicates the definitions that follow are for "dark" used as an adjective. Garcia uses "dark" to describe the girls' hair. The second time the word is listed, it is followed by the abbreviation "n." indicating that "dark" can also be a noun. Note that the second word in the example, "glossy," is also an adjective. In English, adjectives usually come before nouns but they can also follow nouns. Adjectives often come after a form of the **to be** verb: "Their dark hair **was** glossy."

Activity 13D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Reviewing Adjectives

An adjective is a word that describes a noun. Nouns can refer to a thing, a quality, a condition, or an action. You may check a learner dictionary such as Longman's to determine if a word is used as an adjective if this is helpful to you.

Underline the adjectives you used in your interior monologue. If you did not include any adjectives, you can edit your writing to include more descriptive words to modify your nouns.

Day 5

Activity 15: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – The Rhetorical Effects of Adjectives

Purpose: To develop students' ability to analyze the effects and functions of a writer's stylistic choices, including the use of adjectives

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 15: Analyzing the Rhetorical Effects of Adjectives

Step One: Put away your copies of “On Leaving | On Staying Behind,” so that you no longer have these in front of you. Then, without looking back at the poems, add your own adjectives to the poems in all the places where Garcia’s adjectives have been removed. Think about what these adjectives add to our understanding of the poems’ setting, characters, and themes. You’ll notice that some words that function as adjectives have also been omitted.

“On Leaving”

I can run _____ times around the village, my dog beside me. I have tested myself against her speed, my _____ cousins’ endurance. I win.

My cousins go with me this morning, their _____ hair _____, so _____ their shoulders. Their mothers tell me to watch over them.

I have said goodbye to all who remain, _____ village elders, _____ statues of saints in our _____ church, my mother.

I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest of the girl cousins, no _____ beauty, no wealth to keep me here.

I wear only what I have. I carry a blouse one aunt gave me, a friend’s _____ sandals for days when heat persists into the night.

My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early in the morning and at night. When you reach the trains, gain a space in the middle; don’t move. Don’t let anyone steal your space. When we reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing _____ bandanas, not _____ or _____. Those wearing _____ come from our region, they speak our language, they are known to our village.

If no one waits at the border wearing _____, we wait or take our chances. I have waited _____ years for this chance. No more.

If the coyotes separate me from my two cousins, mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life.

They think I don’t know what they mean. I know what a man

can take from a woman. I know my _____ cousins' pride.
I will protect them from their pride, our _____ honor. I will scream
or fight if I can. I will run if I can. I know now how fast I can run.

“On Staying Behind”

She thinks I don't know why she runs. Not to catch the trains
or escape la migra or outrun packs of _____ dogs. I listened
to the advice her cousins sent, the older girl cousins, married,
_____ girls who left our village with their husbands.
The journey is harsh, more than _____ weeks if she's lucky.
So many dangers, only _____ cousins to protect her.
My daughter has no husband. She cannot stay with me. I will
not have her stay with me to starve. She leaves with no wealth.
She and her cousins are their own wealth. I see the strength
in their arms and shoulders, blood that pumps through heart and lungs.
No water, no beans or corn. Today, the woman studying our village,
una profe de los estados unidos, spilled our pot of beans.
This woman has never known hunger. I saw her shock when I sifted
beans from dirt, placed beans, dirt, the bit of water I had planned to use
for grinding the _____ corn. What is a _____ dirt, I thought, the _____ dirt
in which I grew these beans? A child should not see a mother starve to death.
A mother should not hear that her last daughter has disappeared.
I bless this _____ child, daughter of my heart, the one I hoped
would wrap my body in a serape and lay me next to her father
at the edge of the church yard. I bless her journey, wishing
her _____ passage, _____ journey. I have said my prayers
to the _____ saints. I have eaten my _____ meal. I will lay
myself alongside her dog tonight. Perhaps tomorrow, more food
will come my way. Again, I stay behind. I will wait and hope.

Step Two: Now look back at “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” and compare your choice of adjectives to Garcia's choices. What do you notice? How do Garcia's adjectives affect the reader's understanding of the poems' setting, characters, and themes? Discuss your observations and insights in a four-minute quickwrite.

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Activity 16: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Say, Mean, Matter, Do

Purpose: To further develop students’ ability to analyze the significance, effects, and functions of a writer’s stylistic choices

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Students use a modified version of Say, Mean, Matter (Blau 244) to analyze Garcia’s stylistic choices. In this version of the activity, a fourth column has been added to accommodate analysis of rhetorical effects and functions (i.e., what the poet’s choices do), resulting in a four-column chart: Say, Mean, Matter, and Do. For the “Do” column, you might ask students to consider how the quotation they selected for the “Say” column does the work of the poem. In other words, how do the poet’s words help her convey her message and achieve her purpose? What impact do these words have on the reader? Students can draw on their experience with descriptive outlining (See the Assignment Template or Waste More, Want More) to write “do” statements for this activity.

Note: If students’ annotations and responses indicate that they are already thinking critically about the text, they may not need to conduct a subsequent close reading. However, if students’ responses focus primarily on identifying features of the text (e.g., types of evidence, literary or rhetorical devices, etc.) without analyzing the effects and functions of the writer’s choices, they may benefit from additional support reading the text closely and critically. Use formative assessment to determine the level of support your students need.

Activity 16: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Say, Mean, Matter, Do

In Say, Mean, Matter, Do, you will cite, interpret, and analyze direct quotations from the paired poems. Each column addresses a different question about the text:

1. What does it say?
2. What does it mean?
3. Why does it matter?
4. What does it do?

The “Say” and “Mean” columns give you an opportunity to practice selecting and paraphrasing or explaining direct quotations. The “Matter” and “Do” columns give you an opportunity to practice your critical thinking skills. For the final column, use your rhetorical knowledge to analyze the effect and function of the poet’s words. What is the quotation doing rhetorically? How does it affect you as a reader?

See the directions and example that follow:

Say (direct quotation)	Mean (paraphrase or explanation)	Matter (significance and connection to them)	Do (rhetorical effect or function)
“I saw her shock when I sifted/beans from dirt, placed beans, dirt, the bit of water I had planned to use/ for	The lady from the U.S. accidentally dropped a pot of beans. Since the mother is living in poverty, she cannot	This shows the harsh reality of the conditions that the mother and daughter are living in and	Shocks the reader and gives us the truth of how sad their conditions are. Makes us feel sorrow and pity

grinding the last dried corn” (Garcia).	buy more beans. So she went through the dirt to put the dropped beans to use.	explains why people might leave their homeland despite all the risks.	for the characters.

Day 5 – Designated

Activity 14D: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Group Illustration of Imagery

Purpose: To develop students’ ability to analyze stylistic choices—and to communicate effectively in small groups—through a collaborative study of Garcia’s imagery

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Students will need colored markers and chart paper or butcher paper for this activity.

Ask students to form groups. Provide each group with a large sheet of paper and crayons or colored markers. Ask each member of the group to select a different colored crayon or marker. If you’d like more options for colors, each student can choose two crayons or markers and sign their names in both colors.

Activity 14D: Analyzing Stylistic Choices – Group Illustration of Imagery

Imagery is descriptive language that uses the five senses. Garcia’s poems include several examples of imagery, such as the description of the “wooden statues of saints in our small church.” For this activity, you will create a group illustration of one example of imagery from “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.”

Using a large piece of paper and crayons or colored markers, work together to create an illustration of a description of imagery you found in Garcia’s poems. Choose a colored crayon or marker that is different from the colors of everyone else in the group and sign your name on the back of the paper in that color. You may only use your designated color for this activity.

Write the line from the poems containing the imagery across the top of your paper. Be sure to use quotation marks since you are citing directly from “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” Then collaboratively draw a picture illustrating Garcia’s use of imagery in the example you chose. Remember: You may only use your assigned color. If the group needs to use the color red for their drawing, only the student with the red crayon or marker can do this work.

Questioning the Text

Activity 15D: Thinking Critically – Mentor Text for Literary Analysis

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Purpose: To prepare students for writing a literary analysis of Garcia’s poems

Activity 15D: Thinking Critically – Mentor Text for Literary Analysis

We can learn strategies from other writers by studying the features of mentor texts, or models of writing. Try to find a mentor text written in the same genre that you’ll be writing in yourself. This will give you important information about the characteristics of that genre.

In preparation for writing your own one-page literary analysis, you will be reading and analyzing a mentor text: in this case, a short analysis of Sherman Alexie’s novel *The Absolutely True Diary of a Part-Time Indian*. As you read this model essay, consider what it might teach you about how to write a literary analysis. Consider the following questions:

- What kind of claims does the writer make about the meaning of the novel?
- What kind of support does she provide for her claims?
- How does she analyze the significance of her evidence?
- What kind of language does she use?
- How is the essay organized?

Read and annotate the mentor text below before discussing your observations with the class.

In *The Absolutely True Diary of a Part-Time Indian*, Sherman Alexie places the tragedies of the main character, Junior, in direct juxtaposition with his lighthearted tone. This side-by-side comparison allows the reader to learn the truth about how marginalized Junior’s life has been, as well as experience the optimism that is the heart of his survival.

Junior begins the novel with an anecdote about how he was born with too much cerebral spinal fluid inside of his skull, forcing him to undergo surgery at six months old that was predicted to have one of two outcomes; his death, or brain damage so severe he would “live the rest of [his] life as a vegetable” (8). Though the content of his anecdote is tragic, his language is full of jokes; he makes fun of himself for being born with a deformity, “But weirdo me, I was born with too much grease inside my skull...” (8), of the deformity itself, “...like my brain was a giant French fry” (8), and of the physical problems resulting from his brain damage, “...I ended up having forty-two teeth... Ten teeth past human” (8-9). In further describing his physical form, he describes his eyes as “so lopsided” (9), being so skinny he’d “turn sideways and disappear (9), and having a head so big “that little Indian skulls orbited around it” (9). He also informs the reader that he had a stutter and a lisp, “Or maybe I should say... a st-st-st-st-stutter and a lishthththp” (9) and that “Everybody on the rez calls [him] a retard about twice a day” (9).

While the anecdote tells the reader that Junior's life has been tragic since he was born, his silly attitude towards his brain damage, and the permanent effects of it, sets the tone for the rest of the book; one that lets the reader know that Junior prefers to laugh at his hardships as opposed to feel pity for himself. His humor is used as a tactic to downplay the severity of his tragedies, making them seem less invasive and impacting on his life.

Questioning the Text

Day 6

Activity 17: Summarizing and Responding

Purpose: To summarize their takeaway understandings before students complete the reading rhetorically activities and prepare to write rhetorically in response to the issues and ideas raised by Garcia's poems

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 17: Summarizing and Responding

Respond to the following questions in your notes after discussing your ideas with a partner or small group.

- How would you describe the daughter's character?
- How would you describe the mother's character?
- What are the poems saying about the experiences of leaving and staying behind? What challenges and resources are present in each situation? Is one situation more difficult than the other?
- What do the mother and daughter understand about each other? Are there things they don't understand about each other?
- What things might be difficult for mothers and daughters in this situation to talk about? Why?

Activity 18: Thinking Critically – Brief Literary Analysis

Purpose: To make evidence-based interpretive claims about the poems' meaning in a short writing assignment

Suggested Time: 15 minutes (complete as homework)

You may want to allow some class time for students to begin drafting their one-page literary analysis. Encourage students to draw on their annotations, descriptive outlines, dialogic 3-charts, and the Say, Mean, Matter, Do activity as appropriate. Remind students that they have already gathered and analyzed direct quotations they can use for this task

Activity 18: Thinking Critically – Brief Literary Analysis

In an analysis, we examine the relations between parts and whole to see how something works. Write a one-page literary analysis of the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” in which you discuss how the poet creates meaning. Consider the effects and functions of Garcia’s choices. What is she saying and doing? And **how** is she saying and doing these things? Support your interpretive claims with evidence from the poems.

Prepare to write your analysis by closely reading and annotating the poems, noting the poet’s choices about such things as diction, syntax, imagery, tone, figurative language, and any other features of the text you think are important.

Diana Garcia’s poem, “On Leaving | On Staying behind,” tells a story about a young girl who struggles trying to find hope and opportunity and details her hardships of what she has to go through daily. It is one scenario when writer captures the reader’s attention, but it is a whole different scenario when a writer captures the reader’s heart. Garcia’s poems allow her readers to reflect on some of the situations that have affected them and held them back from achieving a goal they once had. Her poems also allow her readers to feel encouraged and fight through their hard times.

Diana Garcia’s powerful poems are in two parts: the first part is “On Leaving,” and the second part is “On Staying behind.” In the first part of the poem, she writes about a young girl who leaves her village to seek a better life for her and her younger cousins. She goes on a long journey and faced with many trials along the way. From a personal perspective, the poem teaches how to build courage and character and to not allow anything blocking your way prevents you from pursuing your goal.

In one of the stanzas of “On Leaving,” she writes, “I go with the blessings of my mother and her sisters. I am the youngest of the girl cousins, no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here.” The young girl is defining her condition and her reasoning for leaving her home and takes on the task of being a leader for younger cousins. Young and understanding she goes, but not without guidance. The poem continues further, “My cousins who have made the journey send this advice: travel early in the morning and at night. This now allows her journey to be at ease but carefully traveled for she makes a mistake, it is on her to secure her younger cousins safety to the other side. ‘When we reach Mexico, we are to look for coyotes wearing yellow bandanas, not red or green. “ The advice becomes more important about how they can reach their destination if the young girl is attentive. As most poems use grammatical language, the “coyotes” are used as metaphors to identify human beings that can be both allies and enemies towards the girl and her cousins. ‘If no one waits at the border wearing yellow, we wait or take our chances. I have waited two years for this chance. No more.” This is where faith and courage begin to be seen because the girl wants better and is willing to give it her all for the opportunity she hopes to find.

Activity 19: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Bring a Text to Class (Homework)

Purpose: To engage students in a study of multiple perspectives by making text-to-text connections

For Activity 19, students find an additional reading selection that demonstrates the extent to which the issues Garcia addresses in her poems are timely and important today. The idea is for students to connect the literary texts to our current social moment themselves. Pairing enduring literary texts with current events and recent publications helps students understand the broader historical, cultural, and social contexts that shape current events.

Activity 19 must be assigned for homework so that students have time to search for a relevant text to bring to class. You may want to allow a few days for students to find their outside reading selection.

Activity 19: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives Part I – Bring a Text to Class (Homework)

Find a recently published source (e.g., newspaper article, scholarly article, blog, photo essay, podcast, etc.) that demonstrates the extent to which the issues Garcia addresses in her poems are timely and important today. Bring this text to class and be prepared to summarize it and explain why you chose it.

This is your opportunity to find and share current texts that add to the conversation.

Text 2 – Fletcher, “Interview with Diana Garcia”

Reading Purposefully

Activity 20: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Interview with Diana Garcia

Purpose: To enable students to “hear” the poet’s explanation about her purpose in writing the two poems and consider the rhetorical situation and exigencies that she was responding to

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

This text is an email interview between poet Diana Garcia and Jennifer Fletcher (the module developer). In her responses, Garcia explains her inspiration and purpose for writing the poems. She describes how she turned her attention to the experiences of young women impacted by war and poverty, particularly those who emigrate to the U.S. alone, after having written a series of poems about the young men who were part of the Bracero Program—the guest worker program that brought millions of Mexican men to the United States on short-term labor contracts.

Activity 20: Considering the Rhetorical Situation – Interview with Diana Garcia

Read the interview with Diana Garcia. Then respond to the following questions in a five-minute quickwrite:

- What other issues and contexts does the interview introduce?
- What does Garcia identify as her purpose for writing the poems?
- What exigencies is Garcia responding to?
- What does this broader context contribute to your understanding of the poems’ themes?

As you search for an additional source, consider how Garcia’s contexts and purpose relate to ongoing conversations on transnational migrations.

Questioning the Text

Activity 21: Reflecting on Your Reading Process – Pairs Conversation and Evidence Chart

Purpose: To support students’ own process of self-assessment and reflection to help them develop expertise as learners

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

If time is short, you may choose to have students complete the evidence chart as homework and reserve the pair’s conversation for a subsequent class meeting. Before passing out the chart, ensure that all students understand the vocabulary. Briefly clarify words and phrases such as “diction” (word choice), “syntax” (sentence structure) and “stasis theory” (a set of questions for developing arguments), but let students know that it is alright for them to skip the abilities that they do not yet feel they have acquired.

Activity 21: Reflecting on Your Reading Process – Pairs Conversation and Evidence Chart

Turn and talk to a partner about how you feel you’re doing with the reading activities so far. What challenges, if any, have you encountered? What have you done to address those challenges?

Now complete the following chart by recording evidence and examples of the reading skills you have been further developing during this module.

I am able to...	Evidence and Examples
Paraphrase the words of other writers	
Consider different perspectives in a rhetorical situation	
Analyze diction, syntax, and imagery	
Analyze tone	
Annotate and question texts	
Make inferences about a text (i.e., understand what is implied but not directly stated)	

Writing Rhetorically

Composing a Draft

Activity 16D: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting Lab for Brief Literary Analysis

Purpose: To provide a supportive learning environment for the composition of students’ first draft of the literary analysis

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

You may want to review key aspects of the writing process with your students first, such as strategies for generating ideas and gathering evidence. Students may also benefit from support in transforming their annotations, dialogic 3-charts, and Say, Mean, Matter, Do exercises into academic prose. Model sentence templates for literary analysis such as those in Graff and Birkenstein’s *They Say, I Say* may be helpful.

Activity 16D: Making choices as Your Write – Drafting Lab for Brief Literary Analysis

You will have a class period to draft your Brief Literary Analysis of the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” Use your work from the reading rhetorically activities in this module—especially the quotations you gathered and analyzed—to compose your analysis.

Preparing to Respond

Discovering What You Think

Day 7

Activity 22: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Creative Response

Purpose: To introduce students to their final writing task(s)

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Writing Task(s):

Students have already had the opportunity to further develop their skill in academic writing through the brief literary analysis. They now will practice using descriptive and literary techniques to produce a creative text in response to the issues raised by “On Leaving | On Staying Behind.” They may choose to write a set of paired poems, a profile feature article, or a brief work of creative nonfiction.

Remind students that they have been analyzing the effects and functions of Garcia’s craft moves, including her use of adjectives and the way she develops her characters and themes. Garcia’s poems are important mentor texts for students who choose to write their own set of paired poems. Students who are interested in writing a profile feature article can use the interview with Garcia as a mentor text while students who choose to write a work of creative nonfiction, such as an autobiographical incident, may draw on the narrative and reflective components of both the poems and the interview.

Garcia’s poems may inspire students in a variety of directions for this final assignment. In identifying the issues that are of the greatest concern to themselves and/or their community, students could decide, for instance, to write about any of the following topics: push and pull factors of emigration, immigration

policy, saying goodbye to a family member, immigrant experiences, leaving home for the first time, leaving home for college, differences in parent-child perspectives, self-reliance or self-efficacy, the risks and rewards of immigration, or any other topic or story related to “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” that students see as especially important right now.

Activity 22: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Creative Response

Consider the topics raised by Garcia in her poems. In what ways are any of them issues in your own life or community? Which of those issues calls urgently for a response now?

Choose one of the following forms of writing to express your ideas:

- A set of paired poems that explore the topic from different perspectives
- A profile feature article
- A work of creative nonfiction (e.g., a memoir or reflective essay)

Your finished piece of writing should be between 650 and 1,000 words in length (lengths will vary according to form). Develop your ideas through focused inquiry, including background research and interviews as needed. Include a Works Cited list for any citations.

Before choosing your genre, consider the kinds of stories that can be told through poetry, feature articles, and creative nonfiction. Whose story do you want to tell? What need or problem do you want to address? What do you want to do about that need or problem? What’s the best way to do this? Select your genre based on your purpose and interests.

A successful response to the task will do all of the following:

- Demonstrate an ability to understand a perspective on its own terms
- Establish the timeliness and importance of the issue
- Engage multiple points of view
- Draw on research into relevant contexts and experiences
- Make strategic use of language choices to create particular meanings and effects
- Make strategic use of organizational choices to develop and support ideas

Rubric Scores:

6—Exceptional

5—Commendable

4—Adequate

3—Limited

2—Inadequate

1—Failing

0—Off-topic or plagiarized

Reading Rhetorically

Questioning the Text

Activity 23: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives Part II – Preparation for Structured Discussion

Purpose: To enable students to prepare for the Structured Discussion by sharing the additional texts they’ve found related to the issues Garcia addresses in her poems

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 23: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives Part II – Preparation for Structured Discussion

To prepare to respond to the rhetorical situation, you will share the outside source you found that relates to the issues and contexts addressed by the poems. Share this source with a small group, summarizing its key points for your peers and explaining the ways it relates to Garcia’s poems. Compare and contrast the different sources you’ve collected as a group. What do the perspectives, issues, and information addressed in your sources add to your understanding of the context for Garcia’s work?

Take note of the titles of the texts your group members share. You may want to use these as sources of inspiration or information for your culminating writing task. Be sure to notice if any of the outside sources are profile feature articles, or articles that offer a focused description of the experience(s) of a single person or group.

Activity 24: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Bring a Text to Class Structured Discussion

Purpose: To invite students to discuss the exigencies that inspired Garcia to write her poems, as well as those needs or problems addressed in outside sources, in preparation for discovering their own purposes for writing

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 24: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Bring a Text to Class Structured Discussion

In your group, number yourselves 1-4. Each person will have a specific role during the discussion (see the discussion questions that follow).

Step One: Students 1 and 2 will begin the discussion while students 3 and 4 take notes in a T-chart. The T-chart will be a record of the main points and examples discussed by Students 1 and 2. Students 1 and 2 will have five minutes for their dialogue.

Student 1	Student 2

Step Two: Student 3 now summarizes the discussion and then asks for elaboration or clarification on one underdeveloped but important point AND joins the conversation while 4 continues to take notes in a three-chart (see the example below). Students 1, 2, and 3 will have seven more minutes to continue the discussion. Try using the sentence starters that follow to help each other elaborate upon and clarify your ideas:

- Can you elaborate on this...?
- What do you mean by...?
- Can you tell me more about...?
- What makes you think that?
- Can you clarify the part about...?
- Can you be more specific?
- How so?

How/why is that important? (Zwiers and Crawford 32)

Student 1	Student 2	Student 3

Student 4 records key points and examples in the 3-chart.

Step Three: Student 4 now gives credit to individuals for significant ideas and synthesizes work of the group into a short statement. Groups may have five minutes for this final step.

First, review the definitions of **exigence** that follow from the Oxford English Dictionary:

Definitions of **exigence** from the OED (accessed February 24, 2018):

1. What is needed or required; a thing wanted or demanded; a requirement, a necessity.
2. A state of urgent need; a situation of trouble or difficulty; an extremity; (in pl.) straits.
3. Urgent need or demand; necessity; emergency; great trouble or difficulty.

Questions for Structured Discussion:

- What exigencies do the mother and daughter face in the paired poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind”? What makes these exigencies particularly urgent and difficult? How do you know?
- What problems or needs were addressed in the outside sources your group members brought to class? How do you feel about the situations you read about or heard about?
- Is there a specific story or person from the sources that stood out? If so, why?
- What particular needs or demands do you see as most important to address? Why? What is required to address these needs or demands?

Preparing to Respond

Discovering What You Think

Activity 17D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Paragraph Reconstruction

Purpose: To offer students additional support understanding the rhetorical and linguistic features of a work of creative nonfiction (in this case, a memoir) by having them reconstruct an excerpt from *The Distance Between Us* by Reyna Grande

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

This excerpt can serve as a mentor text for students who choose to write a brief work of creative nonfiction for the culminating task.

Read students the following paragraph from *The Distance Between Us*:

We talked about the day our parents would return. Carlos’s fantasy was that Papi and Mami would fly to us in their own private helicopter. “I can just picture it,” he said. “It would land here, in the middle of the yard.” We giggled at the image of Papi emerging from the helicopter, his hair blowing in the wind, his face framed by aviator sunglasses as handsome as Pedro Infante, then Mami coming to stand next to him, looking just as glamorous. We pictured the whole colonia rushing over to see them come home. And we would be so proud. (Grande 46)

Activity 17D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Paragraph Reconstruction

In this activity, you will be reconstructing a paragraph from a memoir that your teacher reads aloud to you. As you listen to your teacher, pay attention to the way the writer uses descriptive details and dialogue.

Step One: Take out a blank sheet of paper.

Step Two: Listen as your instructor reads the selected paragraph at a normal rate of speed.

Step Three: Then take notes while your instructor reads the paragraph again; the notes will be essential when composing your paragraph.

Step Four: Reconstruct what you heard using your notes or the key words. Compare what you have written with other students and make changes as necessary.

Step Five: Finally, compare your reconstruction to the original paragraph. Edit your paragraph as needed.

Writing Rhetorically

Composing a Draft

Activity 18D: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting Lab

Purpose: To offer students time and both teacher and peer support as they draft their own descriptive paragraph

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Activity 18D: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting Lab

Now try drafting your own descriptive paragraph. Consider the discussions you’ve had about Diana Garcia’s poems “On Leaving | On Staying Behind” and the issues addressed in outside sources students brought to class. What have you read about or experienced that relates to the topic of immigration? Practice using descriptive language and dialogue to write a paragraph of creative nonfiction (i.e., a true story told using literary techniques).

Share your draft with a partner when ready.

Consider ways you might develop or transform this paragraph for your culminating writing task.

Revising Rhetorically

Day 8

Activity 25: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Gathering Evidence

Purpose: To guide students in considering the kind of material they can draw on from their personal experience and knowledge to develop and support their ideas

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 25: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Gathering Evidence

The kind of inquiry work you will need to do depends upon the genre and topic you selected. For instance, if you have chosen to write a profile feature article (a newspaper or magazine article focusing on a single person or group), you may need to conduct interviews and background research. You may also want to consult resources that offer advice for writing in the genre you have selected. The *New York Times* offers a guide to writing profile feature articles: movies2.nytimes.com/learning/students/writing/voices.html.

Keep in mind that you have already collected evidence and generated ideas through your quickwrites, notes, and annotations. You can also use your personal experience and observations as relevant. Consider the following sources of information:

- What personal experiences can you draw on in developing your response?
- What expertise do you have that can help you contribute to the conversation?
- What connections can you make to your own background and identity?

Organize your notes and readings as needed and work to develop your ideas.

Composing a Draft

Activity 26: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting

Purpose: To support students in generating an initial draft of their composition

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

In this section, students consider the writing task and the relevant resources they have gathered to determine what their initial approach is toward their topic and material. Their ideas may change as they write, research, receive feedback, and revise; this is part of the writing process.

Activity 26: Making Choices as You Write – Drafting

Write a partial rough draft of your poem, article, or short work of creative nonfiction. If you get stuck while drafting, try setting a timer for five minutes and forcing yourself to keep writing—without judgment—until the timer goes off. Continue writing idea chunks until your composition starts to take shape.

Activity 27: Making Choices About Learning Goals

Purpose: To guide students in setting goals for their ongoing development as writers

Suggested Time: 5 minutes

You may choose to assign Activities 27 and 28 as homework if you would like to provide students more time for drafting or for sharing and discussing their drafts.

Activity 27: Making Choices About Learning Goals

Take a moment to consider your growth as a writer. What goals do you have for yourself? Briefly respond to each question that follows in your notes.

- Where am I going? (Describe your task.)
- How am I going? (Describe your progress and process.)
- What do I need to get there? (Set learning goals for yourself.)

Activity 28: Making Choices as You Write – Genre Awareness and Analysis

Purpose: To develop students' awareness of genre features and functions

Suggested Time: 5 minutes

Activity 28: Making Choices as You Write – Genre Awareness and Analysis

For this assignment, you have your choice of writing in one of three forms of creative expression: Poetry, a profile feature article, or creative nonfiction (including memoir writing). Consider the narrative strategies and elements of literary craft that are most appropriate to the genre and subject you've selected. Be sure to review your work analyzing the rhetorical effects of adjectives. Consider, too, the use of signal words or transitions.

Take a look at what you’ve drafted so far.

Now turn and talk to a partner about the genre you’re writing in. Why did you choose this genre? What can this genre do? What kinds of stories can be told through this genre? Are there additional features of this genre that you haven’t used yet (e.g., dialogue, imagery, figurative language, plot events) that you might like to try out?

Negotiating Voices

If students have chosen to include sources in their composition, they may benefit from a review of ways to use the words of other writers. Students may also need assistance formatting dialogue or making choices about point of view.

Revising Rhetorically

Day 8 – Designated

Activity 19D: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically

Use this day for activities that you decide will be most helpful for your students as they revise their essays. For example, you may want to provide additional guidance in how writers sometimes “dress down” their language in academic writing (see Gerald Graff and Cathy Birkenstein, *They Say/I Say*, Chapter 9) or how best to further develop their ideas with elaboration.

If students are reading independently during this module, you may decide instead to use this time to check-in with them on their progress based on their reading logs.

Day 9

Activity 29: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically – Purpose Analysis

Purpose: To guide students in assessing the effectiveness of their writing based on the demands of the rhetorical situation

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Students complete the Purpose Analysis (Fletcher 235) of their draft using the graphic organizer in Activity 29.

Activity 29: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically – Purpose Analysis

Complete the Purpose Analysis of your draft using the graphic organizer below.

WRITER’S CLAIM/POSITION What does the writer say?		
Purpose		
IDEAS Describe what the writer wants the audience to know or understand.	FEELINGS Describe the emotions the writer wants the audience to feel.	ACTIONS Describe what the writer wants the audience to do.
PAST, PRESENT, OR FUTURE Explain whether the writer wants the audience to make a judgment about the past, understand a statement about the present, or decide a course of action for the future.		
Quickwrite How would you describe the purpose of this text? What do you think the writer hopes to accomplish through his or her argument? Does the argument serve multiple purposes? If so, which one(s) is/are most important?		

Fletcher, Jennifer. *Teaching Arguments: Rhetorical Comprehension, Critique, and Response*.
Stenhouse, 2015, p. 235. © 2015

Activity 30: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Reader Feedback

Purpose: To get advice to help students revise their compositions

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 30: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Reader Feedback

You will need a partner for this activity. Partner A will read a paragraph or section aloud from their composition (if the text is a poem, Partner A can read a few lines or a stanza). After Partner A reads the paragraph or section, Partner B will explain what they understand and what they don't understand about what was read. Partner A will continue reading their work aloud, stopping after each section to allow Partner B a chance to respond. After Partner A finishes reading, the pair will switch roles.

Be sure to keep your reader feedback focused on the following two kinds of responses:

- What you understand
- What you need help understanding

As you revise your work, consider ways to help your reader more fully understand your message and purpose.

Activity 20D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Writer Interviews

Purpose: To engage students in structured interviews to gather feedback about their writing

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Activity 20D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Writer Interviews

In this activity, you will be participating in peer interviews as a way to share your writing with a reader. First, choose a partner. Then exchange your writing and read each other's work. Keep in mind that you may be writing in different genres. Take a few moments after you finish reading to share your reactions.

Now you're ready to conduct the interview. One of you will act as the interviewer first. This person will prepare a list of five questions to ask the writer, including the two questions below (these are the same questions Diana Garcia responded to in her interview). Write three more original questions, creating a total of five.

1. What inspired you to write this piece? What problems or needs did you hope to address?
2. What is the context of this piece?
3. ...
4. ...
5. ...

Take turns interviewing each other using this process. Consider the implications of your responses. If you are unsure of the purpose or context for your writing, you may need to do a little more research before preparing your final draft.

Activity 21D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Student-Generated Test Questions

Purpose: To assess what learning students consider important, what kinds of questions they consider fair, and how well they understand key content

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

In this activity, students write questions for a possible quiz after studying the material. Questions could be multiple choice, multiple select, matching, or constructed response. (See Appendix B: Formative Assessment Strategies.)

Activity 21D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Student-Generated Test Questions

Step One: Working in groups of three or four, create a set of six questions that could be used to assess students' knowledge of compare and contrast text structure, adjectives, and personal pronouns. Use your notes and previous activities such as the interior monologue to design your test questions. Questions can be multiple choice, multiple select, matching, or constructed response (short answer).

Example Multiple Choice Question (only one correct answer):

- Which statement best describes what the personal pronouns (e.g., I, we, my) add to the meaning of the poems?

Example Multi Select Questions (multiple correct answers):

- Which sentences use compare and contrast text structure?
- Which transitions can be used to introduce a contrast between two different things?

Try using some of the following sentence templates to write your test questions (adapted from the Smarter Balanced Assessment Consortium's sample ELA/literacy items):

- What does the _____ reveal about the author's point of view?
- What does the use of the word _____ suggest? Select two options.
- How does the _____ affect the _____? Select three options.
- The speaker in the poem implies that _____. Which adjective from the text best supports this idea?

Step Two: Trade questions with another group and answer the other group's set of six questions. Work together, using your notes as needed.

Step Three: Choose the best question from the set to share with the class.

Step Four: Debrief as a whole class, with each group sharing the best question in the question set they answered (i.e., the question that most clearly and effectively assesses students' content knowledge).

Step Five: Say “thank you” and “goodbye” to your group members.

Step Six: Independently review your use of signal words, adjectives, and pronouns in your culminating writing assignment. Make any changes needed to improve the cohesion, clarity, and effectiveness of your writing.

Editing

Day 10

Activity 31: Editing Your Draft – Sample Student Essay

Purpose: To give students practice editing a piece of student writing before they apply what they have learned to their own writing

Suggested Time: 35 minutes

While the first draft of an essay is generally writer-based, as writers revise, they write with the reader in mind, producing writing that is, in other words, more reader-based. At this point, they need to address “local” issues such as grammar and usage, sentence clarity, sentence variety, word choice, and other features. Students benefit from instruction that targets particular features and asks them to make observations about those features and experiment with their use.

Have students independently edit the sample student essay below. When most students have finished, co-create an edited version as a class, talking about the effects of different options. Encourage students to experiment with adding adjectives that more precisely describe the positive and negative effects of immigration. Invite students to consider the connotations of the writer's word choices (e.g., “aliens”) and the assumptions behind the writer's claims. Ask students to notice the way in which the different options are punctuated. Then read the edited version aloud to the class, asking them to notice how much more effective it is compared to the original.

Note that this activity primarily focuses on the skill of academic editing. If students are demonstrating independence with this skill, you may choose to skip to the next activity.

Activity 31: Editing Your Draft – Sample Student Essay

Read the following student essay on the topic of undocumented immigration (used with permission). Edit the essay using the conventions of academic English. Pay careful attention to sentence boundaries, subject-verb agreement, spelling, and punctuation. Add adjectives and transitions in places where you think they will improve the clarity and cohesion of the essay.

You can make your changes on the essay itself. Use the margins or the bottom of the page if you need more room to revise sentences.

Sample Student Essay:

Does illegal immigrations cause more harm to the United States or to the illegal immigrants. Illegal immigration effects the United States as well as the illegal aliens in many ways. The United States is affected positively and negatively, immigrants face many difficulties and dangers. These challenges are many. Including separation from family, loss of innocence, and in many cases death. The negative effects on the United States include more taxes and create crowded housing. While illegal immigration is harmful to both the United States and the immigrants, the struggles that immigrants face on their journey make it worse for them.

Illegal immigrants struggle through many hardships that encourage their decision to migrate to other countries. These reasons including financial instability, starvation, and separation from family members. Garcia clearly shows many examples in her poems. Garcia shows the problem of financial need when she stated, "... no great beauty, no wealth to keep me here". A main reason for immigrants leaving there home country is that they have nothing left to live for there and will not survive if they do not make a change. This financial problem leads into their issue with starvation. Starvation is presented when her mother's thoughts are expressed; "No water, no beans or corn...She cannot stay with me. I will not have her stay with me to starve" (Line 8, 11). Starvation leads her mother to justify sending away her daughter; "A child should not see a mother starve to death" (Line 16). While these hardships and struggles cause pain to illegal immigrant, there are many dangers on the journey itself that bring upon harm as well.

Along with problems like starving, they encounter many dangers on their journeys. Diana Garcia's poems, *On Leaving* | *On Staying Behind*, also shows these dangers they encounter. For example, in *On Leaving*, Garcia states, "... mis primas instruct me to let them take what they will, but not my life, never my life" (Line 19, 20). This suggests that on immigrant's journeys, they cannot stand up for themselves, they must give in to anything in order to protect themselves. *On Staying Behind* expresses the mother's worries when she says, "The journey is harsh, more than two weeks if she's lucky" (Line 5), and "So many dangers, only two younger male cousins to protect her" (Line 6). Unfortunately these dangers and hardships are only the ones immigrants will face before arriving to a new country, if they survive the journey, new struggles are placed of them once they arrive. Such as deportation fears and to find a job to start there new lives.

It might be believed that immigration is more harmful to the United States due to the crowded housing, taxes, and American jobs. Immigration does effect property values negatively as there are many illegal families renting out rooms rather than apartments and tax rates of United States citizens does inflate to include the education of the children of illegal immigrants. However, the claim that immigrants are "stealing" American jobs is just an opinion, it's not a proven fact; "One study from the National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) found that immigration leads to labor specialization, which increases total factor productivity" (Jacqueline Varas). This statement shows that immigrant worker do specific jobs that they have the ability and skills necessary to do. This is how illegal immigrants help the United States economy, not hurt it.

Illegal immigration is harmful to both United States and the immigrants. While both are harmed immigrants receive most of the hardships and struggles do to the dangerous

journey and difficult family situations. The United States economy benefits from these illegal immigrants. There is an increase in factor productivity as well as in employment opportunities.

Activity 32: Editing Your Draft – Your Own Essay

Purpose: To enable students to apply the strategies they just practiced to the task of editing their own essay

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 32: Editing Your Draft – Your Own Essay

Now spend several minutes editing your own composition, applying what you learned from editing a sample student essay as a class. Keep in mind that while a profile feature article will typically follow the conventions of standardized English, poetry and creative nonfiction may not. Make choices about grammar, usage, and mechanics that are appropriate to your genre and purpose.

Activity 33: Editing Your Draft – Proofreading

Purpose: To guide students in making one last pass through their draft before submitting their work

Proofreading focuses primarily on error detection. At this point, students are no longer working to make substantive changes. Activity 34 may be assigned for homework along with Activity 33 if students need more time to edit their essays.

Activity 33: Editing Your Draft – Proofreading

Choose a section of your essay to read in reverse. Scan your eyes from right to left across the page, reading the words backwards. This strategy can sometimes help you detect errors that you miss during a regular reading. Be sure your work has been carefully proofread before you share it with your intended audience.

Activity 34: Preparing Your Draft for Publication

The final step of the composing process is to share the work with its intended audience. This will include formatting your composition for submission to your teacher, as well as sharing your work with any external audiences you may have identified, including friends and family. Consider submitting poems, articles, and creative nonfiction for publication. Jennifer Gonzalez’s blog on the Web site, *The Cult of Pedagogy*, offers a helpful list of places to publish student writing: www.cultofpedagogy.com/publish-student-art-writing/. Profile feature articles may also be submitted to school or local newspapers.

Activity 22D: Editing Your Draft – Interior Monologue

Purpose: To give students practice by having them edit their interior monologues (see Activity 12D: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Interior Monologue) before they apply what they have learned to their own culminating writing task

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Return students' interior monologues (if you collected them), and ask students to edit based on what they've learned by doing the activities in this module. Direct students to add adjectives and transitions when appropriate. Encourage them to consider the effectiveness of their pronoun choices, too. Because the interior monologue is a casual and creative form of writing intended to represent a person's thoughts, it is unlikely that students' monologues will have a formal text structure. Nevertheless, there are still some compare and contrast signal words that may be appropriate for describing the differences between the character's (i.e., the cousin or the professor) and the speaker's (i.e., the daughter or the mother) perspectives. Remind students to check their punctuation when they are finished.

Activity 22D: Editing Your Draft – Interior Monologue

Return to the interior monologue you wrote earlier in the module. Add adjectives and transitions in your monologue when appropriate, using compare and contrast words to express the similarities and differences between characters. Evaluate your use of pronouns and make any necessary changes.

Check your punctuation when you are finished.

Activity 23D: Editing Your Draft – Your Own Essay

Purpose: To give students an opportunity to apply what they have learned about rhetorical grammar to their culminating writing task

Suggested Time: 40 minutes

You may want to reproduce copies of the Editing Checklist from the ERWC 2.0 Assignment Template (Appendix K, Part II) or display this document electronically. Remind students about what they have learned about editing in previous modules.

Activity 23D: Editing Your Draft – Your Own Essay

Now consider the final edits you need to make to your essay to prepare it for submission. Write two or three language or documentation features (e.g., transitions, pronouns, citations, etc.) that you want to focus on based on feedback you have received on your previous writing, including combining sentences. Read your draft multiple times, editing for one feature at a time.

Use an editing checklist provided by your teacher to guide your work.

Activity 35: Reflecting on Your Writing Process

Activities 35 and 36 may be completed as homework after students have submitted their final drafts. An alternative is to have students complete these reflections in class prior to beginning the next module.

Activity 35: Reflecting on Your Writing Process

Quickwrite: What have you learned about your ability to take effective rhetorical action in response to issues and needs that you care about? How will you apply this learning in the future?

Activity 36: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals

Activity 36: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals

Finally, revisit the questions you asked yourself at the start of this module:

- What strengths do I have as a reader and writer that I can build on?
- What do I want to learn how to do or do better?
- What do I need to keep me moving forward in my intellectual growth?

What learning goals did you set for yourself? Locate these in your notes. What did you do to imagine and create your success as you engaged the learning experiences in this module?

Reflect on your learning goals in a five-minute quickwrite.

Reflecting on Your Teaching Process

After you have finished teaching the module and evaluating students' work, take some time to reflect on your teaching practice. Consider the following questions:

- What went well and what might you change?
- How did you (or could you) adapt the activities for various ability levels?
- What markers of various skill levels (e.g. proficient, developing) did you notice during formative assessment?
- What did gradual release of responsibility look like for this module?
- In what ways did you develop your ability as a teacher to make the experience of the module productive for all students, including English learners?
- What goals do you have for yourself as you begin the next module?

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